

# Luke Schenker Product Designer · Strategy, Systems, Leadership

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**Product Designer of 7+ years** leading design and research strategy, building and mentoring cross-functional teams, and driving measurable business and user impact. Operating at Senior-Staff scope, I bridge micro-level craft with macro-level product and business context - from guiding engineers and PMs at Uber ATG to founding and commercializing Anew, a mental health startup that reduced user anxiety by 49%. I thrive in complexity, turning ambiguity into clarity, and I'm energized by helping both teams and products grow.

*Work History - See portfolio for more*

## Anew / Founder · Product Design & Strategy Lead

2020 - 2025, 5 years 3 months

- **Defined and executed product strategy** for Anew, a smartphone OS for guided self-treatment of negative behavioral and mental health effects of phone use; owned design, research, product, and engineering integration from idea through commercialization.
- **Led end-to-end design and research** from low-fidelity exploration to commercialization, employing a hybrid methodology that combined psychological research with UX research to improve both treatment efficacy and product experience.
- **Structured and managed 6 masters-level internships** with Carnegie Mellon masters graduates across design, research, and engineering - accelerating production and cutting ~8 months off dev/research timeline.
- **Drove measurable impact**, with the pilot achieving a **49% reduction in daily user anxiety**, validated within a \$11B market (+4% YoY).
- **Prototyped and delivered** designs and developed in Kotlin + Jetpack Compose with Firebase + S3 stack; integrated research findings into production MVP in under 3 months.
- **Authored *The Nonobvious Fix*** (255 pg), a book codifying Anew's research frameworks and design theory.

## Uber ATG / Senior Interaction Designer

2018 - 2020, 1 year 5 months

- **Owned product design strategy** as the sole designer for Map Maker, the core internal tool transforming raw AV data into high-accuracy maps; partnered daily with PM, engineering, and operations to align product goals with technical feasibility.
- **Increased mapper efficiency by 27% overall**, saving \$72k/month in Pittsburgh and projecting **\$400k+/month total savings** with coming India expansion, through the design and launch of a scalable hotkey schema with rapid onboarding.
- **Improved key annotation workflows by up to 70%** (conflicts) and 60%+ (portions + snapping), cutting user friction and rework, reducing critical operational risk and directly enabling expansion.
- **Drove cross-functional alignment** by leading weekly stakeholder reviews and iterative design sessions with 4 senior engineers, resolving concerns (e.g., data integrity, zoom functionality) before development which reduced rework and design/technical debt.
- **Led research with 40+ full-time users** through daily observation, interviews, usability tests, and collaborative brainstorming (including QA and engineering co-research), ensuring solutions were validated, adopted smoothly upon release, and loved by our users.

## John Hancock Financial / UX Designer

2016 - 2017, 1 year

- **Led UX research and design for two new initiatives:** an internal forex trading app and an external insurance shopping app.
- **Established design practice from scratch**, as 1 of 3 first design hires, by teaching and embedding UX research and design best practices into PM and engineering workflows.
- **Delivered competitive advantage**, with the insurance shopping app outperforming 3 global divisions' products in an internal competition.

### Skills & Technologies

**Design:** Systems Thinking, Interaction Design, Visual Hierarchy, Design Processes, Brand Integration

**Research:** Mixed-Methods UX Research, Study Design, Usability Testing, Surveys, Interviews

**Collaboration & Leadership:** Cross-Functional Leadership, Stakeholder Alignment & Facilitation, Mentorship

**Prototyping & Technology:** Figma, Kotlin/Compose, HTML/CSS/JS, Firebase, AI-Assisted Prototyping, Low/High Fidelity and Functional Prototyping

### Selected Achievements

**Achieved 49% anxiety reduction** with Anew Smartphone OS pilot.

**Increased product efficiency** by 27% at Uber ATG, achieving \$72K/month immediate savings and \$400k/mo projected savings.

**Wake Forest University guest speaker** on leadership and executive communication, repeatedly.

### Education

## Carnegie Mellon University

### Self-Defined BA (HCI/CS)

2011 - 2015, 4 years

- Led HCI capstone team; project **received \$1.4M in further government funding.**
- Co-founded startup that raised **\$125k in angel investment.**